September 18, 2026

**Prof. Michael Carolan**
Editor
British Food Journal

Re: Manuscript BFJ-07-2026-1291

Thank you for your message regarding the third-round evaluation of our manuscript entitled “The Emerging Research Frontier of Food Analytics: Artificial Intelligence, Consumer Analytics, Smart Food Systems, and Knowledge-Driven Intelligence.” We appreciate the opportunity to address the remaining comments and the editorial guidance provided by the *British Food Journal*.

We appreciate the reviewer’s positive assessment of the revised manuscript, particularly the recognition of its methodological originality, its contribution beyond conventional bibliometric trend analysis, and the value of integrating descriptor normalization, emergence indicators, document-level co-word analysis, and community detection. We have carefully considered each comment raised in this third round and made additional revisions to improve the study's clarity, transparency, interpretation, and reporting.

In the following table, we provide a structured, point-by-point response to all issues raised in this third round. For each comment, we explain how it has been addressed, identify where the requested issue had already been addressed in the previous revision rounds when applicable, and describe any additional modification introduced in the manuscript. All new modifications are clearly indicated in the tracked-changes version submitted with the revised manuscript.

**Methodological clarification to the Editor and Reviewer.** As established in the first revision and reiterated in the second, this study is a technological-intelligence investigation conducted through bibliometric tech-mining methods, rather than a conventional systematic or bibliometric literature review. Its analytical workflow constructs and normalizes descriptors from bibliographic and textual information, identifies temporal emergence at the descriptor level, and subsequently analyzes the co-occurrence structure of the resulting emergent research frontier. We appreciate that the reviewer now explicitly recognizes the methodological originality of this approach and its distinction from conventional bibliometric trend analysis.

However, we consider it important to draw the Editor’s attention to a methodological issue that has persisted throughout the review process. Several methodological requirements raised again in the present report were explicitly considered and addressed in one or both previous review rounds, in some cases through substantial point-by-point methodological explanations and corresponding revisions to the manuscript. Their recurrence therefore does not reflect an absence of response or methodological information. Rather, it reflects a continuing disagreement regarding which analytical requirements apply to the study as designed.

More importantly, some recurring requests are not methodologically applicable to the investigation conducted. They presuppose analytical operations, validation criteria, or reporting frameworks belonging to a different research design. Accommodating them would therefore not constitute further clarification or strengthening of the present study; it would require retrospectively transforming the study into a different investigation. Methodological rigor requires evaluating a study against the logic of the research design actually implemented, rather than imposing post hoc analytical procedures derived from a different methodological framework.

This distinction has been consistently stated since the first revision. The study was designed as a technological-intelligence investigation using bibliometric tech-mining methods, in which an enriched and normalized descriptor space is constructed, temporal emergence is identified at the descriptor level, and the relational organization of the resulting emergent descriptors is subsequently examined through co-word analysis and community detection. It was not designed as a conventional bibliometric review, a keyword-mapping exercise, or a clustering-validation study. Requirements specific to those different analytical designs cannot automatically be treated as validity requirements for the present investigation.

We have nevertheless reconsidered every request in the present report and have implemented all revisions that genuinely improve the transparency, reproducibility, reporting, interpretation, or limitations of the study without altering its research design. Conversely, we have not introduced retrospective analyses merely to conform the investigation to methodological requirements external to its analytical logic. Where a requested procedure is not applicable, the point-by-point responses below identify the issue, document how it was addressed in the previous review rounds, and explain the methodological basis for not introducing it.

Given that some of these requirements have now persisted across three rounds despite explicit methodological explanations and corresponding manuscript revisions, we respectfully ask the Editor to adjudicate the remaining methodological disagreement. Further accommodation of these particular requirements would no longer constitute revision of the study as conducted but would require its retrospective redesign. We therefore ask that the methodological adequacy of the manuscript be assessed based on its research objective, analytical design, procedures actually implemented, transparency and reproducibility of reporting, and explicitly acknowledged limitations, rather than on conformity with analytical procedures from a different methodological framework.

**Table 1.**

Comments from the review report.

| Commentary | Answer to Reviewers |
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| **Strengthen the methodological justification of the bibliometric research design.** The Methods section provides a detailed description of the research workflow, including database selection, search strategy, descriptor preparation, emergence detection, and thematic clustering. However, the manuscript would benefit from a stronger justification regarding why a technological-intelligence bibliometric approach is the most appropriate method for identifying the emerging frontier of Food Analytics. The authors should clarify the methodological distinction between the present approach and conventional bibliometric mapping techniques. Specifically, the manuscript should explain how descriptor-level emergence analysis contributes additional insights beyond traditional keyword frequency analysis, citation analysis, or thematic mapping approaches. The authors have stated that the study focuses on identifying emerging rather than established research topics; therefore, this methodological contribution should be emphasized more explicitly. | This methodological distinction was addressed substantially during the previous review rounds and is already developed in Section 2.4 of the manuscript evaluated in the present round. In response to the second-round request concerning the theoretical value of descriptor-level emergence, Section 2.4 was specifically strengthened to distinguish the information produced by conventional bibliometric mapping from that produced by the present emergence-oriented design. The manuscript explains that frequency, citation, and co-occurrence patterns primarily characterize the prominence and structure of topics represented in a literature, whereas descriptor-level emergence evaluates whether normalized concepts exhibit a temporally distinctive combination of novelty, persistence, and recent growth. It further explains that this distinction allows comparatively small but rapidly developing signals, as well as processes of acceleration, recombination, and convergence, to be identified before they necessarily become dominant within the broader thematic structure.<br><br>We nevertheless agree with the reviewer that the methodological rationale for selecting this design can be made more explicit within the Methods section itself. We have therefore added a concise clarification to Section 3.1 explaining why the technological-intelligence design is particularly appropriate for the research objective. Specifically, the revised text now emphasizes that temporal emergence is evaluated at the descriptor level before thematic network construction, rather than inferred from topic prominence in the overall literature. It also clarifies that, unlike conventional frequency-, citation-, or co-occurrence-based mapping, this analytical sequence permits comparatively small but persistent and rapidly developing research signals to be identified before examining how those emergent concepts are relationally organized.<br><br>This addition complements, rather than duplicates, the more extensive methodological positioning already provided in Section 2.4: Section 2.4 establishes the contribution relative to previous bibliometric and technology-focused research, while Section 3.1 now states explicitly why the technological-intelligence design is appropriate for identifying an emerging research frontier. |
| **Improve transparency and reproducibility of the search strategy.** The manuscript provides information regarding the use of Scopus as the database source and reports seven complementary Boolean queries developed through an iterative process. This represents a strength of the study. However, the main manuscript should provide a concise explanation of the conceptual logic behind these search strategies. The authors should briefly explain: why multiple search strategies were required; how the strict search differed from the main and complementary searches; and how sensitivity between retrieval coverage and precision was managed. Although the complete search strings are provided in the supplementary file, summarizing the search framework within the main manuscript would improve reproducibility and allow readers to better evaluate the comprehensiveness of the dataset. | This issue was addressed in detail during the previous review rounds and is already explicitly documented in Section 3.1.2 and Table 4 of the manuscript evaluated in the present round. In response to the previous requests for greater search transparency and reproducibility, Section 3.1.2 was substantially expanded to explain the conceptual and empirical logic underlying the seven-query strategy, while the complete executable search strings were retained in Supplementary File S1.<br><br>Specifically, the main manuscript already explains the three elements identified in the present comment. First, it explains why multiple searches were required: complementary queries reduced dependence on any single label for Food Analytics by capturing alternative terminology and adjacent application vocabularies, while eligibility screening controlled the additional off-domain retrieval associated with broader coverage. Second, it distinguishes the strict search from the other searches: six queries underwent iterative empirical refinement through repeated execution and inspection of retrieved records, whereas the strict search retained the ten initial high-specificity expressions unchanged as a precision-oriented anchor. Third, it explains how coverage and precision were balanced: candidate terms and structural modifications were |

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| | evaluated through repeated retrieval and corpus inspection, competing formulations were re-executed when they produced conflicting indications regarding coverage and precision, and refinement stopped when further changes produced no substantively new domain-relevant terminology or risked compromising complementary coverage.<br><br>Table 4 further documents this process separately for the Strict, Main 1–3, and Complementary 1–3 searches by reporting the source of candidate modifications, the corresponding decision and rationale, retrieval trajectories, and stopping criteria. The supplementary file then provides the complete executable Boolean queries. Thus, the conceptual search framework requested in the present comment is already summarized in the main manuscript, while the supplementary material provides the level of detail required for exact replication.<br><br>Because these elements were incorporated into the manuscript in response to the previous review rounds and are already present in the version evaluated in this round, we have not added further repetitive text to Section 3.1.2. We have instead retained the existing division between the conceptual and empirical explanation in the main manuscript and the complete executable search strings in Supplementary File S1. |
| **Provide additional clarification regarding screening and eligibility decisions.** The manuscript explains that screening was conducted by a single researcher supported by computational filtering. While this approach may be acceptable for bibliometric mapping studies, additional explanation is needed regarding how potential selection bias was minimized. The authors should consider adding: examples of borderline records and how inclusion decisions were determined; procedures used to maintain consistency during screening; and additional validation procedures, if available. Clarifying these aspects would strengthen confidence in the reliability of the final corpus. | This issue was addressed substantially in the previous review rounds. The manuscript already explains that screening was conducted in two stages with computational support, that predefined eligibility criteria were applied consistently across records, that computational filtering identified candidate exclusions followed by researcher validation, and that a separate title-and-abstract assessment was conducted against the operational definition of Food Analytics. It also explicitly acknowledges that screening was conducted by a single researcher and that independent inter-reviewer validation and agreement statistics were therefore not performed.<br><br>In response to the present comment, we have added a concise clarification to Section 3.2 illustrating how borderline eligibility decisions were resolved. The revised text explains that the determining criterion was whether the analytical or computational component made a substantive contribution to a food-system objective. It provides examples already represented in the predefined eligibility criteria: agriculture-focused records without a direct food-related connection and clinical-nutrition records without a Food Analytics contribution were excluded, whereas records were retained when the analytical method was substantively linked to a food-related objective.<br><br>We have not reported additional independent validation procedures because none were performed. Rather than retrospectively introducing a validation procedure that was not part of the study design, the manuscript transparently reports the screening process actually implemented and explicitly acknowledges single-researcher screening as a limitation in Section 6. |
| **Expand explanation of descriptor normalization procedures.** The descriptor preparation stage is a critical component of this study because normalized descriptors serve as the foundation for emergence detection and thematic clustering. The manuscript should provide additional examples of descriptor normalization decisions, particularly regarding: synonym consolidation; acronym handling; conceptual equivalence assessment; and decisions for retaining similar but conceptually distinct terms. Providing several examples would improve methodological transparency and allow other researchers to replicate the analytical workflow. | This issue was addressed in detail during the previous review rounds and is already explicitly documented in Section 3.3 of the manuscript evaluated in the present round. The descriptor-normalization procedure was substantially expanded to distinguish deterministic lexical normalization from similarity-based candidate generation and subsequent conceptual validation.<br><br>Specifically, Section 3.3 already explains the four aspects identified in the present comment. Synonyms and acronyms were consolidated only when conceptual equivalence was established in the bibliographic context; similarity-based procedures, including fuzzy matching and stem variations, were used to identify candidate matches rather than to merge descriptors automatically; each candidate match was manually reviewed before consolidation; and lexically similar descriptors representing distinct concepts were explicitly retained separately. The manuscript also provides concrete examples, including the consolidation of “AI” with “artificial intelligence,” “agri-food” with “agrifood,” and singular/plural variants under common descriptors.<br><br>Importantly, the normalization process was iterative and conceptual rather than a fixed one-to-one lexical replacement procedure. As already explained in Section 3.3, normalized descriptors constitute the analytical units used for subsequent emergence and co-occurrence analysis, and descriptor preparation was therefore treated as a conceptual measurement stage. The manuscript |

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| | consequently reports the decision rules and representative examples needed to understand and reproduce the analytical logic without presenting the complete study-specific thesaurus as though it were a universal normalization dictionary.<br><br>Because the requested normalization procedures, decision logic, and representative examples are already explicitly reported in the manuscript evaluated in this round, no additional modification to the manuscript was made for this comment. |
| **Provide stronger justification for parameter selection in emergence analysis.** The authors appropriately report the criteria used for identifying emergent descriptors, including novelty threshold, minimum frequency, persistence requirement, and growth ratio threshold. However, the rationale for selecting these parameters requires further explanation. The authors should clarify whether these thresholds were selected based on: theoretical considerations; methodological recommendations from previous studies; or empirical optimization through sensitivity analysis. The discussion should emphasize why the selected configuration represents an appropriate balance between identifying meaningful emerging topics and avoiding unstable or isolated signals. | The manuscript already reports the complete parameter configuration and explains the operational role of novelty, persistence, minimum frequency, and recent-to-baseline growth in identifying emergent descriptors. It also reports that the growth-ratio threshold was examined through sensitivity analysis from 1.00 to 1.20 in increments of 0.01, with 1.12 selected as the final value.<br><br>We agree that the basis for parameter selection can be distinguished more explicitly. Section 3.5.1 has therefore been clarified to state that the configuration combines the conceptual emergence criteria derived from Porter et al.'s framework with study-specific operational thresholds intended to exclude sparse or short-lived signals. Importantly, these fixed criteria were not selected through multidimensional empirical optimization. The empirical sensitivity analysis was conducted specifically for the growth-ratio threshold, as already reported in the manuscript.<br><br>This clarification also makes explicit the balance underlying the configuration. Novelty limits established baseline activity, persistence excludes isolated temporal appearances, minimum frequency requires sufficient empirical support, and the growth criterion requires increased recent activity. Their joint application therefore restricts emergence to descriptors exhibiting recent development with sufficient persistence and empirical support, rather than descriptors appearing only sporadically. The revision clarifies this methodological rationale without implying additional parameter optimization or sensitivity analyses that were not performed. |
| **Strengthen comparison between findings and previous literature.** The Discussion section provides a comprehensive interpretation of the four identified dimensions: Intelligent food quality and composition analytics; Predictive and operational food-system analytics; Personalized nutrition and consumer analytics; and Semantic, generative, and knowledge-driven food analytics. However, the discussion should provide a more explicit comparison with previous systematic reviews and bibliometric studies. The authors should clarify: which findings confirm previous observations; which findings extend existing knowledge; and which findings represent genuinely new research directions. For example, the emergence of semantic, generative, and knowledge-driven Food Analytics could be discussed more critically in relation to previous studies focusing mainly on AI applications, supply chains, or smart food systems. | This issue was addressed explicitly during the previous review round and is already incorporated into the Discussion of the manuscript evaluated in the present round. The Discussion was specifically expanded to distinguish continuity with previous research from the extensions revealed by the present emergence analysis.<br><br>The current manuscript already compares the four dimensions with previous reviews and bibliometric studies. It explains that intelligent food quality and composition analytics confirms and extends earlier observations concerning AI and machine-learning applications in food processing, quality assessment, and safety; that predictive and operational food-system analytics extends established work on supply chains, traceability, and smart food systems toward increasingly integrated predictive and operational applications; and that personalized nutrition and consumer analytics builds on established research concerning dietary behavior and personalized nutrition while showing their increasing integration with data-driven and adaptive analytical approaches.<br><br>The Discussion also explicitly identifies semantic, generative, and knowledge-driven Food Analytics as the dimension that most clearly extends the structures emphasized in previous literature. Rather than presenting generative AI, language models, knowledge graphs, and semantic technologies as isolated technological developments, the manuscript interprets their co-emergence as evidence of increasing integration between semantic representation, generative methods, heterogeneous food information, and knowledge-driven analytical systems. At the same time, the manuscript deliberately avoids claiming that every component of this dimension is entirely new. The contribution lies in identifying their emergence and convergence within the Food Analytics research frontier rather than merely documenting the existence of the individual technologies.<br><br>Therefore, the distinction requested in the present comment—between findings that confirm previous observations, findings that extend existing knowledge, and the research direction that most clearly represents an emerging development—is already explicitly articulated in the Discussion. No additional modification to the manuscript was made for this comment. |

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| **Strengthen the theoretical contribution of the manuscript.** The manuscript provides an interesting conceptualization of Food Analytics as an interconnected socio-technical research domain. However, the theoretical implications should be further developed. The authors should clarify whether Food Analytics should be positioned as: an extension of artificial intelligence applications in food systems; an interdisciplinary convergence between food science, information systems, and data science; or an emerging scientific domain with its own conceptual identity. A stronger theoretical positioning would enhance the contribution of the manuscript beyond descriptive bibliometric mapping. | This theoretical positioning was explicitly strengthened during the previous review round and is already articulated in the Discussion of the manuscript evaluated in the present round. The current manuscript does not conceptualize Food Analytics merely as an extension of artificial intelligence applications to food systems. Rather, it positions the field as an emerging interdisciplinary and socio-technical domain produced through the convergence of food science, information systems, artificial intelligence, consumer analytics, and decision sciences.<br><br>Specifically, the Discussion states that the four identified dimensions challenge interpretations of Food Analytics as either a collection of independent analytical applications or a simple transfer of artificial intelligence techniques into food-related contexts. It further characterizes Food Analytics as a convergent field in which analytical methods, domain knowledge, data infrastructures, human behavior, and decision processes increasingly interact. The four dimensions provide the empirical and conceptual structure supporting this interpretation.<br><br>The manuscript therefore already addresses the alternatives raised in the present comment. Artificial intelligence is interpreted as an important transversal technological component of Food Analytics, but not as its defining conceptual boundary. Interdisciplinary convergence explains the field's underlying structure, while the recurring integration of these analytical, technological, domain-specific, and decision-oriented components supports its emerging conceptual identity as Food Analytics. This theoretical positioning is also consistent with the operational definition established earlier in the manuscript, which delimits the field through the substantive integration of food-related data or evidence with analytical or computational methods to generate food-system-specific knowledge or decision support.<br><br>Because this theoretical positioning was incorporated into the manuscript during the previous revision and is already explicitly stated in the version evaluated in the present round, no additional modification to the manuscript was made for this comment. |
| **Enhance discussion of practical implications.** The manuscript discusses implications for researchers, food-industry stakeholders, technology developers, and policymakers. However, these implications could be further developed into more actionable recommendations. The authors should provide additional discussion regarding: implementation challenges in real-world food systems; requirements for data governance and interoperability; challenges related to explainable AI and responsible deployment; and potential barriers for organizations with limited technological resources. This would strengthen the connection between research findings and practical applications. | This issue was addressed substantially during the previous revision and is already developed in the Discussion of the manuscript evaluated in the present round. The current Discussion extends the implications beyond stakeholder identification and explicitly addresses the practical conditions and barriers affecting the translation of emerging Food Analytics research into real-world applications.<br><br>Specifically, the manuscript discusses fragmented and heterogeneous data, interoperability limitations, model transferability, explainability, privacy, bias, computational costs, regulatory uncertainty, and unequal access to technological infrastructure as barriers to implementation. It also identifies interoperable and FAIR-oriented data infrastructures, explainable and robust analytical models, appropriate governance mechanisms, and responsible implementation as priorities for translating the identified research frontier into practice. These considerations directly address the challenges of data governance and interoperability, explainable and responsible AI deployment, and implementation in organizations operating under technological and resource constraints.<br><br>The Discussion further emphasizes that the emergence of a research topic should not be interpreted as evidence of technological maturity or successful implementation. This distinction is particularly important for the practical implications of the study because it prevents emerging research trajectories from being presented as already validated solutions and instead frames them as areas requiring further validation, infrastructure development, governance, and implementation research.<br><br>Because the implementation challenges and practical requirements identified in the present comment are already explicitly discussed in the manuscript evaluated in this round, no additional modification to the manuscript was made for this comment. |
| **Expand limitations and future research directions.** The limitations section appropriately acknowledges several methodological constraints, including dependence on Scopus, terminology-based retrieval, single-researcher screening, and | We agree that the limitations section can more explicitly connect the acknowledged methodological constraints with directions for future |

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| sensitivity of emergence analysis parameters. The authors are encouraged to expand this section by discussing future methodological improvements, including: integration of multiple bibliographic databases; expert-based validation of emerging themes; longitudinal monitoring of identified research trajectories; and development of open and reproducible bibliometric pipelines. Such discussion would demonstrate stronger awareness of future methodological development in bibliometric research. | methodological development. Section 6 has therefore been expanded with a concise paragraph addressing the four opportunities identified in the comment.<br><br>Specifically, the revised manuscript identifies multi-database retrieval, accompanied by appropriate harmonization of indexing and metadata differences, as a means of assessing the robustness of the identified frontier across bibliographic sources. It also identifies expert-based validation as a potential complement to descriptor- and network-based thematic interpretation and longitudinal monitoring as a means of examining whether the emergent trajectories identified in the present study persist, consolidate, transform, or decline over time. Finally, the revised section identifies the development of open and reproducible implementations of comparable bibliometric tech-mining workflows as a future methodological opportunity for facilitating independent replication and adaptation.<br><br>These additions extend the limitations already reported in the manuscript into explicit directions for future methodological research without implying that procedures not performed in the present study formed part of its validation. |
| **Consider alignment with bibliometric reporting guidelines.** Because this manuscript represents a bibliometric review, the authors are encouraged to consider incorporating recommendations from the BIBLIO guideline proposed by Montazeri et al. (2023), which provides minimum reporting requirements for bibliometric reviews. | This issue was explicitly addressed in both previous review rounds. We respectfully clarify that the premise of the present comment—that "this manuscript represents a bibliometric review"—does not correspond to the research design of the study. As established in the first revision, reiterated in the second revision, and explicitly stated in Section 3.1 of the manuscript evaluated in the present round, this study is a technological-intelligence investigation conducted using bibliometric tech-mining methods, rather than a conventional bibliometric review.<br><br>Montazeri et al. (2023) and the BIBLIO guideline were already considered during the previous review process. As explained in our previous responses, BIBLIO proposes minimum reporting recommendations specifically for bibliometric reviews. It does not constitute a methodology for conducting the technological-intelligence analysis implemented in the present study. We have therefore considered reporting recommendations of this kind where they are applicable and improve transparency or reproducibility, without treating a reporting guideline developed for a different study design as the methodological framework governing this investigation.<br><br>This distinction is substantive rather than terminological. The present study constructs and normalizes a descriptor space from bibliographic and textual information, identifies temporal emergence at the descriptor level, and subsequently examines the co-occurrence structure of the resulting emergent research frontier. Its purpose is therefore not to conduct a bibliometric review of an established literature but to identify and characterize emerging research signals through a technological-intelligence workflow.<br><br>Because the methodological identity of the study is already explicitly established in the manuscript, and because the applicability of BIBLIO has been considered and explained in both previous review rounds, no additional modification to the manuscript was made for this comment. |
| **Recommended references.** The reviewer recommends considering eight additional references to strengthen methodological positioning, validation, comparison with bibliometric trend-analysis approaches, interdisciplinary contextualization, review methodology, and reporting transparency: Azizan (2025); Rahman et al. (2025); Ong et al. (2025); Abdullah et al. (2024); Adawiyah et al. (2023); Azizan et al. (2026); Zupic and Čater (2015); and Montazeri et al. (2023). | We carefully reconsidered the eight references suggested in the present review. Seven of these references had already been recommended or considered during the previous review rounds, and their potential relevance to the manuscript was evaluated at that stage. As explained in our previous responses, suggested references were incorporated only when they provided direct methodological or substantive support for the research design, analytical procedures, or interpretation of the present study, rather than on the basis of their use of bibliometric methods alone.<br><br>We also evaluated the newly suggested reference by Zupic and Čater (2015). We recognize its relevance as a general methodological contribution to bibliometric methods and science mapping. However, the manuscript already provides methodological support for the bibliometric and science-mapping procedures actually employed, while the distinctive component of the present design concerns descriptor-level emergence within a technological-intelligence workflow. We therefore did not identify a specific methodological claim in the manuscript requiring this additional general bibliometric reference.<br><br>Similarly, the other suggested publications were reconsidered in relation to the specific methodological and substantive claims of the manuscript. Studies employing bibliometric trend analysis in other substantive domains do not, by |

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| | themselves, provide methodological validation for the technological-intelligence design implemented here. Montazeri et al. (2023) was also reconsidered, as discussed in our response to the preceding comment, but BIBLIO is a reporting guideline for bibliometric reviews and does not constitute the methodological framework governing the present technological-intelligence investigation.<br><br>We have therefore retained the references that directly support the study's methodological procedures and substantive interpretation rather than expanding the reference list with publications whose relevance is primarily based on their general use of bibliometric approaches. No additional modification to the manuscript was made for this comment. |
| **Quality of communication and editorial consistency.** The manuscript is generally well written, structured, and accessible to readers interested in food science, information systems, and technology management. However, the reviewer recommends further language polishing to improve precision, readability, and consistency, including simplifying overly complex sentences where appropriate, clarifying specialized methodological terminology for interdisciplinary readers, defining acronyms consistently at first use, and correcting grammatical, typographical, and wording inconsistencies. | In response to this comment, the complete manuscript underwent an additional language and editorial review using Grammarly Pro, followed by authorial review to ensure that the suggested changes preserved the intended technical and methodological meaning. The review covered grammar, spelling, punctuation, sentence clarity and readability, wording consistency, acronym usage, and consistency of specialized methodological terminology.<br><br>This process resulted in corrections throughout the manuscript, including grammatical and typographical errors, wording inconsistencies, unnecessarily complex constructions where simplification improved readability, and inconsistencies in American English usage. We also reviewed acronyms at first use and specialized methodological terminology to improve accessibility for the interdisciplinary readership of the journal.<br><br>The language-editing process was editorial rather than substantive. It did not alter the research design, analytical procedures, results, or interpretation of the findings. All resulting corrections are reflected in the revised manuscript. |

Thank you once again for this opportunity to improve our manuscript. During the revision process, please let me know if you need any additional instructions or clarifications.

Sincerely,

**The Authors.**